

D594

Public Health Leadership and Administration

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

The director of a county health department with 85 employees and a newly opened building rallies staff around a vision of ending childhood lead poisoning in five years. She meets one-on-one with each staffer about growth goals and asks teams to rethink old outreach methods. Which leadership style is she using?

- A. Bureaucratic, because a large department needs rules.
- B. Laissez-faire.
- C. Transformational.
- D. Transactional.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager sets monthly restaurant inspection quotas, pays a bonus when inspectors meet them, and writes up anyone who falls short. Which style is this?

- A. Transformational.
- B. Transactional.
- C. Laissez-faire.
- D. Servant.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A new epidemiologist just finished her degree and is eager to lead her first outbreak investigation. The team works out of a renovated courthouse downtown. She has never interviewed cases. What style should her supervisor use for this task?

- A. The same style the supervisor uses for everyone.
- B. Delegating, since she is eager.
- C. Directing: clear, step-by-step instructions and close follow-up.
- D. Supporting: encourage her and let her decide the steps.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A public health nurse with 20 years of immunization clinic experience is confident and skilled. What style fits when assigning her to run this year's flu clinics?

- A. Directing, because every flu season is new.
- B. Directing.
- C. Coaching.
- D. Delegating.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Childhood vaccination rates in one neighborhood fell 12 points after rumors spread in parent groups. Many parents say they distrust the health department. The director, who holds an MBA, wants to hire a design firm to make a better flyer. What does the situation call for?

- A. Treat it as adaptive: engage parents and trusted local messengers to rebuild trust.
- B. A business-style marketing plan, drawing on the director's MBA.
- C. Experts can always solve this with the right data.
- D. A better flyer, since it is a communication design problem.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these is a technical problem rather than an adaptive challenge?

- A. Two merging agencies disagree about their core mission.
- B. The lab's vaccine freezer failed, and a certified vendor can repair it.
- C. Staff resist a new team-based care model.
- D. A community distrusts outside health workers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

At its third meeting in the public library's conference room, a new cross-agency task force argues about who owns which tasks, and two members challenge the chair's agenda. The group includes eight agencies. Which stage is the team in?

- A. The team has failed and should be disbanded.
- B. Forming.
- C. Storming.
- D. Performing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A task force has just worked through its disputes over roles. What stage typically comes next?

- A.** Adjourning.
- B.** Performing, skipping every other stage.
- C.** Forming.
- D.** Norming, as members agree on roles and ways of working.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A health department wants to switch from faxed disease reports to electronic case reporting. Staff are comfortable with fax, and the fax machines were replaced two years ago. The director wants to start by buying software. By Kotter's model, what should come first?

- A.** Build a sense of urgency by showing the delays and risks of fax reporting.
- B.** Mandate the switch; change always succeeds if required.
- C.** Anchor the change in the culture.
- D.** Buy and install the software.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

During a livestreamed council meeting, a council member blames the health director for a foodborne outbreak. The director feels angry. The meeting runs long, and the room is overheated. What response best shows emotional intelligence?

- A.** Show data that proves the council member wrong in front of everyone.
- B.** Pause, acknowledge the concern, and calmly explain the response plan.
- C.** Leaders should never feel or show emotion.
- D.** Ask to adjourn because the room is too hot.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A hospital, school district, YMCA, and food bank formed a coalition to reduce childhood obesity and pooled \$1.2 million. Each partner runs its own programs and reports its own success measures, and no organization coordinates. What is the coalition most missing?

- A.** Shared measurement and a backbone organization.
- B.** More partners.
- C.** More money.
- D.** Each partner keeping separate goals.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A deputy director sits on a panel choosing a vendor for a \$500,000 mobile clinic contract. Her brother-in-law owns one of the bidding companies, which has excellent customer reviews. She believes she can be fair. What should she do?

- A.** It is a conflict only if she receives money.
- B.** Vote for the company, since its reviews are excellent.
- C.** Stay on the panel, since she believes she can be fair.
- D.** Disclose the relationship and recuse herself from the decision.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

The director of a county health department ~~with 85 employees and a newly opened building~~ rallies staff around a vision of ending childhood lead poisoning in five years. She meets one-on-one with each staffer about growth goals and asks teams to rethink old outreach methods. Which leadership style is she using?

Target word: name the style **Decides:** Vision, individual attention, and intellectual challenge.

A	Camouflage	Department size does not define her style.
B	Adjacent category	Laissez-faire is hands-off; she is highly engaged.
C	Correct	Those three behaviors define transformational leadership.
D	Inverted operation	Transactional relies on rewards and corrections, not shared vision.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A manager sets monthly restaurant inspection quotas, pays a bonus when inspectors meet them, and writes up anyone who falls short. Which style is this?

Target word: name the style from exchange behaviors **Decides:** Rewards and corrections tied to targets.

A	Inverted operation	No vision or individual development is present.
B	Correct	An exchange of rewards for performance.
C	Confusion set	He is actively monitoring, not hands-off.
D	Adjacent category	Servant leaders put followers' growth first.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A new epidemiologist just finished her degree and is eager to lead her first outbreak investigation. ~~The team works out of a renovated courthouse downtown.~~ She has never interviewed cases. What style should her supervisor use for this task?

Target word: style for a new learner **Decides:** High commitment, low competence on this task.

A	Absolute language	Situational leadership adjusts to each person and task.
B	Inverted operation	Delegating fits high competence, not just enthusiasm.
C	Correct	Enthusiastic beginners need direction.
D	Adjacent category	Supporting fits capable people with low confidence.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A public health nurse with 20 years of immunization clinic experience is confident and skilled. What style fits when assigning her to run this year's flu clinics?

Target word: style for a high-competence, high-commitment follower **Decides:** Capable and confident.

A	Absolute language	Her experience carries over to this task.
B	Inverted operation	Directing fits beginners.
C	Adjacent category	Coaching fits developing staff with some skill.
D	Correct	High competence and commitment call for delegation.

5. Answer A Concept 3

Childhood vaccination rates in one neighborhood fell 12 points after rumors spread in parent groups. Many parents say they distrust the health department. The director, ~~who holds an MBA~~, wants to hire a design firm to make a better flyer. What does the situation call for?

Target word: adaptive vs. technical **Decides:** The root is trust and beliefs, which need engagement.

A	Correct	Adaptive challenges require people to change; experts alone cannot fix them.
B	Camouflage	The degree does not change the type of challenge.
C	Absolute language	Data alone does not rebuild trust.
D	Adjacent category	A technical fix for an adaptive problem.

6. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Which of these is a technical problem rather than an adaptive challenge?

Target word: identify technical **Decides:** Known fix applied by an expert.

A	Inverted operation	Values and identity conflict is adaptive.
B	Correct	A known solution applied by experts.
C	Confusion set	Changing habits is adaptive.
D	Adjacent category	Trust is adaptive work.

7. Answer C Concept 4

At its third meeting ~~in the public library's conference room~~, a new cross-agency task force argues about who owns which tasks, and two members challenge the chair's agenda. ~~The group includes eight agencies~~. Which stage is the team in?

Target word: name the stage **Decides:** Conflict over roles and leadership = storming.

A	Absolute language	Storming is a normal stage.
B	Adjacent category	Forming is polite and tentative.
C	Correct	Role and authority conflict marks storming.
D	Inverted operation	Performing teams work smoothly.

8. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A task force has just worked through its disputes over roles. What stage typically comes next?

Target word: next stage after storming **Decides:** Norming follows storming.

A	Confusion set	Adjourning comes when the work ends.
B	Dropped element	Skips norming.
C	Inverted operation	Forming comes before storming.
D	Correct	Norming follows storming.

9. Answer A Concept 5

A health department wants to switch from faxed disease reports to electronic case reporting. Staff are comfortable with fax, ~~and the fax machines were replaced two years ago.~~ The director wants to start by buying software. By Kotter's model, what should come first?

Target word: first step of change **Decides:** Create urgency.

A	Correct	Urgency is step one.
B	Absolute language	Mandates without buy-in often fail.
C	Confusion set	That is the last step.
D	Inverted operation	Tools come after urgency and coalition.

10. Answer B Concept 6

During a livestreamed council meeting, a council member blames the health director for a foodborne outbreak. The director feels angry. ~~The meeting runs long, and the room is overheated.~~ What response best shows emotional intelligence?

Target word: EI response **Decides:** Regulate own emotion and respond to the concern with empathy.

A	Adjacent category	Wins the point but escalates the conflict.
B	Correct	Self-regulation plus empathy.
C	Absolute language	EI is managing emotions, not erasing them.
D	Camouflage	Avoids the concern.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A hospital, school district, YMCA, and food bank formed a coalition to reduce childhood obesity ~~and pooled \$1.2 million.~~ Each partner runs its own programs and reports its own success measures, and no organization coordinates. What is the coalition most missing?

Target word: missing collective-impact condition **Decides:** No shared measures and no backbone.

A	Correct	Both conditions are absent.
B	Dropped element	Adding partners does not create alignment.
C	Camouflage	Funding is present; coordination is not.
D	Inverted operation	Collective impact needs a common agenda.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A deputy director sits on a panel choosing a vendor for a \$500,000 mobile clinic contract. Her brother-in-law owns one of the bidding companies, ~~which has excellent customer reviews.~~ She believes she can be fair. What should she do?

Target word: COI handling **Decides:** A family stake in a bidder.

A	Absolute language	Family interests create a conflict too.
B	Camouflage	Reviews do not remove the conflict.
C	Adjacent category	Personal belief does not remove a conflict.
D	Correct	Disclosure and recusal manage the conflict.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Transformational vs. transactional leadership	Transformational leaders inspire through shared vision, individual attention, and intellectual challenge; transactional leaders manage through clear targets, rewards, and corrections.	Labeling any effective or popular leader transformational.	Vision and mentoring vs. quotas, bonuses, and corrections.
2	Situational leadership	Match the style to the follower's competence and commitment on the task: direct new learners, coach and support as they develop, delegate to the capable and confident.	Using one style for everyone, or delegating to an eager beginner.	A staff member's experience and confidence on a specific task.
3	Adaptive vs. technical challenges	Technical problems have known solutions experts can apply; adaptive challenges require people to change beliefs, values, or behavior, so leaders must engage those affected.	Applying an expert fix to a problem rooted in trust or values.	Resistance, mistrust, or conflicting values vs. a broken tool with a known repair.
4	Stages of team development	Teams move through forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning; conflict over roles and direction marks storming.	Reading early conflict as team failure, or mistaking politeness for performance.	How members are behaving toward each other and the leader at a given point.
5	Leading change (Kotter)	Change starts by creating a sense of urgency and building a guiding coalition before tools are rolled out; anchoring in culture comes last.	Starting with the new system or a mandate before people see why change is needed.	A planned change and a question about the first step.
6	Emotional intelligence	Effective leaders recognize and regulate their own emotions and respond with empathy to others' concerns.	Thinking leaders should either hit back or suppress all emotion.	A leader under personal attack or pressure in a public or tense moment.
7	Collective impact across sectors	Cross-sector coalitions need a common agenda, shared measurement, mutually reinforcing activities, continuous communication, and a backbone organization.	Believing more partners or more money alone makes a coalition work.	Many partners working in parallel with different measures and no coordinator.
8	Conflict of interest	A leader with a personal or family stake in a decision must disclose it and step out of that decision.	Believing personal fairness or the absence of direct payment removes the conflict.	A relative, business tie, or gift linked to a party in a decision.

Course scope (public description): Public Health Leadership & Administration Learners apply leadership principles for public health leadership positions. This includes engaging, organizing, and leading diverse groups, as well as addressing ethical issues in the field of public health. Learners also apply negotiation and mediation skills to address challenges they may face in the organization or community.